

Blue Ribbon Chocolate Ice Cream

Makes between 1 and 1½ quarts ice cream

Dark chocolate (10%)
100g | 4 ounces, chopped

Milk chocolate (5%)
50g | 2 ounces, chopped

Cocoa powder (2%)
20g | 3 tablespoons

Kosher or sea salt
3g | ½ teaspoon

Milk powder (2%)
20g | 3 tablespoons

Sugar (15%)
150g | ¾ cup

Cream (16%)
160g | ¾ cup

Milk (45%)
450g | 2¼ cups

Glucose (5%)
50g | ¼ cup

Texture agent of your choice
(see below)

As a child, the closest scoop shop to our house was Baskin-Robbins. It's where most of my early childhood ice cream memories were created; my wide eyes stared at the ice cream cakes shaped like castles, with cones for turrets, while my sisters decided on a flavor. I never needed time to decide; I was a die-hard chocolate-fudge fan; it was twice as chocolaty as the regular chocolate ice cream next to it, and so dark it seemed black.

As a lifetime member of the chocolate ice cream fan club, I've added chocolate to ice cream in just about every way imaginable, and this is the crown jewel in my collection. After tasting many a chocolate ice cream and gelato in Europe, I realized the fudgy flavor of the ice creams I grew up with was unique. This is because American ice cream makers use cocoa powder, whereas ice cream makers in Europe favor melted chocolate. I combine both styles, making for a super-chocolate flavor, and I'd like to think this ice cream would be worthy of the highest American praise, a blue ribbon at a state fair.

You can substitute all milk or dark chocolate for the three chocolates, perhaps using a fancy single-origin, bean-to-bar chocolate. The unique flavor of the chocolate you choose will ring true here.

Milk chocolate has a lot more sugar in it than dark chocolate, so while you can use all milk chocolate in this recipe, you will end up with a very sweet, soft scoop. If it were me, I'd reduce the sugar to 10% (100g | ½ cup) and increase the cream to 23% (230g | 1 cup plus 2 tablespoons).

Melt the chocolates. Fill a medium pot with 2 inches of water, and place the pot over high heat until it comes to a boil, then reduce the heat to a simmer. Place the dark chocolate, milk chocolate, cocoa powder, and salt in a metal or glass bowl with a rim about 2 inches higher than the pot and nest it over the pot of simmering water, making sure the bottom of the bowl does not touch the water. Melt the chocolates, stirring occasionally, until smooth. Remove the bowl from the pot, wipe the bottom dry of any condensation, and set aside in a warm place.

Combine the milk powder and sugar. Mix the milk powder and sugar ① in a small bowl.

Boil the dairy. Place the cream, milk, and glucose in a medium heavy-bottomed saucepan over medium-high heat and cook, whisking occasionally to discourage the milk from scorching, until it comes to a full rolling boil.

Add and cook the milk powder. Whisk the milk powder mixture into the pot. Reduce the heat to a low simmer and continue cooking for 2 minutes ④, whisking to prevent scorching ③.

Combine the ice cream base and chocolate. Whisk one-third of the hot base into the bowl of melted chocolate. Add the remaining dairy in two more additions, whisking between each. (By adding the hot ice cream base to the chocolate gradually, you ensure there are no minuscule flecks of unmixed chocolate in the final ice cream, which feel grainy when frozen.)

Chill. Fill a large bowl two-thirds of the way with a lot of ice and a little water. Nest the bowl of warm chocolate base into this ice bath, stirring occasionally until it cools down ②.

Strain. When the ice cream base is cool to the touch (50°F or below), strain it through a fine-mesh sieve. (This step is optional, but will help ensure the smoothest ice cream possible.)

Cure. Transfer the base to the refrigerator to cure for 4 hours, or preferably overnight. (This step is also optional, but the texture will be much improved with it.)

Churn. Place the base into the bowl of an ice cream maker and churn according to the manufacturer's instructions. The ice cream is ready when it thickens into the texture of soft-serve ice cream and holds its shape, typically 20 to 30 minutes.

Harden. To freeze your ice cream in the American hard-pack style, immediately transfer it to a container with an airtight lid. Press plastic wrap directly on the surface of the ice cream to prevent ice crystals from forming, cover, and store it in your freezer until it hardens completely, between 4 and 12 hours. Or, feel free to enjoy your ice cream immediately; the texture will be similar to soft-serve.



TEXTURE AGENTS

① **Best texture**
Commercial stabilizer
3g | 1 teaspoon mixed
with the sugar before it
is added to the dairy.

② **Least icy**
Guar or xanthan gum
1g | ¼ teaspoon whirled
in a blender with the ice
cream base after it is
chilled in the ice bath.

③ **Easiest to use**
Tapioca starch
5g | 2 teaspoons mixed
with 20g | 2 tablespoons
of cold milk, whisked
into the ice cream
base after it is finished
cooking.

④ **Most accessible**
Cornstarch
10g | 1 tablespoon plus
1 teaspoon, mixed with
20g | 2 tablespoons of
cold milk, whisked into
the simmering dairy,
then cooked for 1 minute.